

the best picks. Have a piece of paper with you that lists everyone's sizes and measurements so you don't have to remember as you browse.

- **Thrift Stores** – This is another great place to find kids' clothes, and I would also add jeans, dress pants, skirts, and dresses for adults to the mix as well. I usually avoid the shirt section because the quality is not always the best if it's been worn before. The wear and tear of a top that's been stained or stretched doesn't make me feel cute—I don't care how cheap it is. I also don't do used shoes, but that's because it makes me pretty squeamish to think of wearing an item previously on someone else's feet!

It's easy to get overwhelmed at the thrift store, so I recommend sticking to the color palette you know looks good on you and only shopping those sections of the store. Most thrift stores I've been to organize their racks that way anyway. I would also make sure you have enough time and patience to browse. You're more likely to find that gem you've been searching for if you're patient enough to really dig.

- **Consignment Shops** – Consignment shops are a bit different from thrift stores in that they usually sell high quality items that are *slightly* used, and focus on quality brands in a big way. You can also donate your own clothing items and get credit towards another purchase you make in-store.

If at first you don't succeed with used clothing stores, don't give up right away! It all depends on the type of shop and where it's located. Don't be afraid to experiment in another neighborhood or even a nearby city to see if you find better items at even better prices. You never know which wealthy family will donate a few gems from their expensive closet!

READER TIP:

I recently ordered from ThredUp and Schoola and LOVED them! I lucked out and found 50% off codes on both of their Facebook pages, so that really made my money go a long way.

—Kristen, JoyfullyThriving.com